

05-14-2024 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pveLJJCMTzY
Publication Date	2024-05-15T09:50:34Z
Target Category	mcs

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report: Muncie Community Schools Board of Education

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearings or separate committee work sessions were held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the meeting to order [00:10:14](#), leading attendees in a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Presiding Officer:** Identified as leading the board proceedings.
 - **Board Members Present:** All members of the board were present (noted during the meeting [00:44:27](#)).
 - **Key Administrative Staff Present:** Dr. K (Superintendent), Mr. Durham (Chief Financial Officer / Financial Presenter), Dr. Reynolds.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - Opening moment of silence and Pledge of Allegiance led by student volunteer Hikaru Laspina 00:10:11.
 - Recognition of the Westview Math Team for placing 1st in the red class (out of 118 teams) statewide and scoring in the top 10 overall in Indiana 00:11:18. Team members and coaches introduced themselves and discussed competition formats 00:12:12.
 - Recognition of Renee Voss (Muncie Central senior and Delaware County female recipient of the Manny Morris/Woof Boom Radio scholarship) 00:18:21.
 - Recognition of district retirees for long-term service exceeding 100 combined years: Kimberly beer, Judith Everheart, Richard Gates, Clara Monroe, John McB, and Jack Wowski 00:26:01.
- **Approval of Minutes:** *(Not explicitly discussed or voted upon in the provided transcript text).*

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:26:44 Addition and Approval of Confidential Litigation Settlement Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presiding Board Officer / Legal Counsel.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board discussed adding a confidential settlement agreement regarding active litigation to the consent agenda. The agreement was previously reviewed in an executive session and is contingent upon final approval by the Delaware County court having jurisdiction.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (included in the combined consent agenda motion).
- **00:28:27 April 2024 Financial Report**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Durham, Chief Financial Officer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Durham presented the April financial results (month 4 of the calendar year). Highlights included:
 - Receipt of the state basic grant of approximately \$3.9 million for the month (projected at \$47.8 million annually, subject to fall enrollment re-estimation).
 - Overall cash balance across all funds stood at just over \$30.6 million at the end of April, with a projected year-end cash balance over \$30 million and an anticipated education fund surplus.
 - Continued monthly state loan payments of \$150,000.
 - Estimated 2024 property tax receipts projected at \$12.3 million (up from \$11.8 million last year), offset by a circuit breaker reduction impact of approximately

\$11.1 million.

- Ongoing legislative advocacy efforts regarding operational funding challenges caused by tax caps.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:34:54](#).
 - **00:35:01 2024 General Obligation Bond Issue (Fieldhouse Renovations & Stadium Project)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Durham / Jane Hearen (Attorney).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for permission to approve the 2024 General Obligation Bond issue totaling \$6.1 million in bond proceeds. Funds will finance renovations at the Muncie Central campus, specifically replacing the heating and cooling system in the Muncie Fieldhouse (which currently lacks cooling and experienced a boiler failure) and completing the stadium project by installing the South restroom area with new electrical and HVAC. The district aims to structure the payback to remain tax-neutral without increasing debt service tax rates. The process includes publishing a notice of public hearing for the additional appropriation.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:37:01](#).
 - **00:37:15 Updated Student Handbook and Family Resource Guide**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Dr. Reynolds presented the updated 2024-2025 student handbook and family resource guide. Changes include a restorative approach to discipline and compliance with new state legislation regarding wireless communication devices/cell phones. The middle school instructional day is defined as 9:00 AM to 4:00 PM, and middle school cell phone rules return to pre-COVID locker storage policies (off and away in lockers during the instructional day). High school implementation details are still under review.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:41:31](#) (subject to the formal definition of the instructional day).
 - **00:41:46 2024 Summer Professional Development (PD) Offerings**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented a slate of professional development opportunities for teachers, administrators, and instructional assistants, supported by Ball State University partnerships and grant funding. Focus areas include middle school literacy curriculum adoption, science of reading in elementaries, rubric support, and special education training, with stipends attached.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:43:58](#).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No general public comment period or floor remarks from citizen attendees were recorded during this portion of the meeting transcript.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Dr. K announced the inaugural "State of the School" meeting held last week with the Governor and Ball State President Merm.
 - Annual Teacher Appreciation event scheduled for the following night (4:00 PM<U+2013>6:00 PM at Minnetrista), organized by Allison Quirk.
 - Art Show and "Celebrate Excellence" event at the Fieldhouse on Thursday (5:00 PM<U+2013>7:00 PM), with displays continuing Friday and Saturday.
 - Summer programs list available on the district website.
 - Open Door Health Hustle providing free immunizations and student physicals on Saturday (9:00 AM<U+2013>2:00 PM at 260 West White River Boulevard).
 - Transitioning district family communications to the "Parent Square" platform.
 - High school graduation scheduled for June 3rd.
 - Upcoming discussions in August regarding the 2025 budget and tax cap impact reports.
 - Brief board discussion regarding upcoming state mandates on third-grade reading retention laws taking full effect for the 2025-2026 school year (based on spring 2025 tests).
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote [00:47:38](#).
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